

India-China Trade and Atmanirbhar Bharat



For Prelims: Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme , Phased Manufacturing Programme , Active pharmaceutical ingredients , Lithium-ion battery cells , Rare earth magnet

For Mains: India-China economic relations and their strategic implications, Self-reliance versus globalisation, Economic interdependence as both an opportunity and strategic vulnerability.

Source: TH

Why in News?

India's widening trade deficit with China has highlighted a key contradiction in **Atmanirbhar Bharat** : while India's manufacturing capacity is expanding, much of this growth continues to depend on **Chinese intermediate goods, components and capital goods** , creating an **"assembly trap"** rather than deep manufacturing self-reliance.

Summary

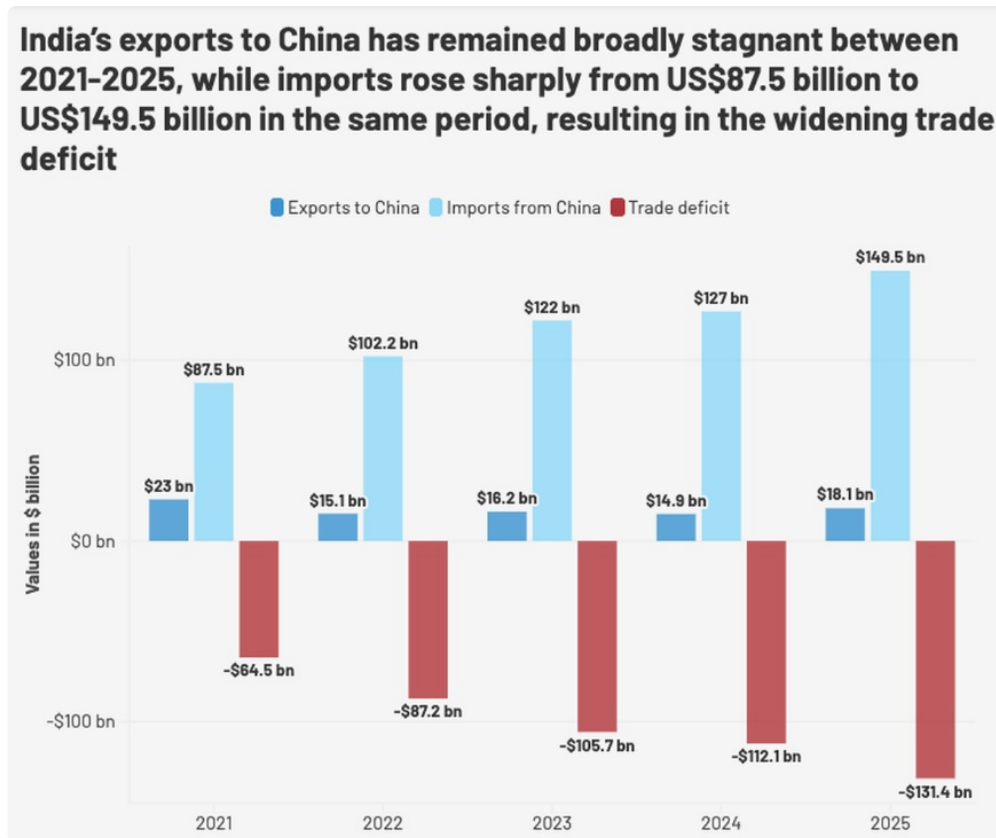
- India's widening trade deficit with China reflects deep dependence on Chinese intermediate goods, components and capital goods, creating an "assembly trap" despite rising domestic manufacturing.
- True Atmanirbharta requires moving beyond assembly through domestic value addition, component manufacturing, R&D, MSME development and diversified global supply chains.

What is the Current State of India-China Trade?

- **Surging Trade Deficit:** Total bilateral trade reached **USD 167.6 billion in 2025**. India's trade deficit with China widened to **USD 112.16 billion in 2025-26**, from USD 99.21 billion in 2024-25.
 - Between 2021 and 2025, India's exports to China remained largely stagnant, while **imports surged by nearly 71%, from USD 87.5 billion to USD 149.5 billion**.
- **Nature of Imports:** The deficit is not driven by Indian consumers buying finished Chinese retail goods. Rather, **intermediate goods constitute nearly 70%** of total imports, and **capital goods account**

for another 22% .

- **Sectoral Concentration:** China supplied 80% or more of India's imports in 636 tariff lines in FY26, compared with 461 tariff lines in FY19, indicating deeper penetration across multiple manufacturing segments.
 - Approximately 80% of India's imports from China are highly concentrated in just four groups: **electronics, machinery, organic chemicals, and plastics. Electronics alone accounts for around USD 38 billion.**



What are the Key Concerns for India's Self-Reliance Amid Rising Dependence on China?

- **The "Assembly Trap" & Low DVA:** Industrial policies such as **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme** and the **Phased Manufacturing Programme (PMP)** have expanded downstream electronics assembly, but the lack of a strong **domestic precision-component ecosystem** has kept India dependent on Chinese inputs.
 - In smartphone manufacturing, the share of imported parts and sub-assemblies in the China import basket rose from **3.3% in 2022 to 10.1% in 2025**, indicating limited **domestic value addition (DVA)** despite rising production and exports.
- **WTO ITA & Domestic Capability Gap:** India's participation in the **WTO Information Technology Agreement (ITA)** reduced tariffs on several IT products, while the **absence of strong domestic electronics champions** limited India's ability to compete with Chinese manufacturers.
- **Input-Driven Trade Deficit:** Unlike **Western consumer-driven deficits**, India's reliance on China is industrial. Complete disengagement would **halt Indian factory lines, not just empty retail shelves.**
- **Colonial-Pattern Trade Basket:** India primarily exports low-value-added primary commodities (raw iron ore, cotton, marine products) to China while importing high-value capital and intermediate technological goods, cementing an unequal terms-of-trade dynamic.
- **Strategic Sector Vulnerabilities:**

- **Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs):** India is the "pharmacy of the world," yet it relies on China for **65% to 70% of its basic active pharmaceutical ingredients , intermediates, and key starting materials (KSMs)**.
 - Earlier institutions such as Hindustan Antibiotics Limited (1954) and Indian Drugs and Pharmaceuticals Limited (1961) sought to build domestic API capacity, but their decline contributed to India's growing dependence on imported pharmaceutical inputs.
- **Green Energy Transition:** Over 75% to 80% of solar cells and modules, along with critical components for **electric vehicles (EVs)** and **lithium-ion battery cells** , are sourced from China, **leaving India's climate goals externally leveraged**.
- **Advanced Electronics & Semiconductors:** Integrated circuits, telecom equipment, and **printed circuit board assemblies (PCBAs) account for almost a quarter of all imports from China**, exposing India's digital economy to foreign hardware dependencies.
- **Critical Minerals & Rare Earths:** China controls roughly **90% of global rare earth magnet manufacturing**.
 - Heavy reliance on a geopolitical rival leaves vital sectors exposed to strategic chokepoints. For example, when **China imposed export controls on rare earth magnets in April 2025**, Indian auto-manufacturers faced immediate production slowdowns.
- **Weak MSME Ecosystem and R&D Deficit: Inverted duty structures** can make raw materials costlier than imported semi-knocked-down kits, discouraging domestic tier-2 and tier-3 component manufacturers.
 - Meanwhile, **India's R&D expenditure** remains around 0.64–0.7% of GDP, while easy access to low-cost Chinese components can reduce incentives for firms to invest in indigenous technology and innovation.
- **Export Competitiveness Dilemma:** Decades of massive state subsidies, integrated industrial clusters, and economies of scale **make Chinese components significantly cheaper than domestic or Western alternatives**.
 - Imposing high customs duties or blanket restrictions on Chinese intermediate inputs directly **raises production costs for Indian manufacturers**.
 - Consequently, finished Indian exports (such as formulated generic drugs or assembled electronics) **risk losing price competitiveness in global markets**.
 - Moreover, lower direct imports from China may not necessarily mean lower dependence if goods are **rerouted through third countries such as Hong Kong**.
 - Unlike several East Asian economies that **strengthened domestic industries before liberalising trade** , India opened its markets **without building sufficient manufacturing competitiveness** , increasing vulnerability to import competition.

What Measures can India Take to Boost Self-Reliance?

- **Shifting Focus to Deep-Tier Manufacturing:** Future iterations of PLI schemes must transition away from rewarding final assembly and explicitly incentivize **Domestic Value Addition (DVA)** , precision tooling, and the **creation of local supplier networks** .
 - Ministries running PLI schemes should rigorously map value chains to identify exact local value-addition gaps, targeting specific missing components (like **specific mobile ICs or solar cells**) for indigenization.
- **From “Make in India” to “Design in India”:** Expand **Design-Linked Incentives (DLI)** to critical

sectors such as telecom and EVs, beyond semiconductors.

- Promote **indigenous IP and product design** to capture higher value and reduce technological dependence.
- **Promoting Circular Economy:** India generated 13.98 lakh tonnes of e-waste in 2024–25, up from 12.54 lakh tonnes in 2023–24.
 - Strengthening the **recycling of e-waste**, solar panels and spent EV batteries can recover critical minerals such as lithium, cobalt and rare earths, reducing import dependence and providing a domestic buffer against Chinese export restrictions.
- **Pursuing "Guarded Globalisation":** India must leverage **friendshoring** and the **"China Plus One" strategy** by building trusted supply-chain partnerships with tech hubs across Taiwan, Japan, South Korea, Europe, and **ASEAN** to de-risk critical component sourcing.
- **Calibrated Tariff Strategy:** Disruptive blanket import bans hurt domestic factories. Instead, the government should deploy phased, **targeted tariffs only on specific components** where viable domestic substitutes exist, giving MSMEs a protected incubation window.
- **Building MSME Component Champions:** India should shift policy focus from large final assemblers to tier-2 and tier-3 MSME suppliers by providing **shared R&D facilities, plug-and-play manufacturing clusters and affordable credit**, thereby strengthening the missing middle of the precision-component ecosystem.

Conclusion

True Atmanirbharta requires moving beyond downstream assembly and blanket import restrictions. India must focus on **upstream value addition, component manufacturing, R&D, precision engineering and supply-chain diversification** to build a resilient and technologically self-reliant industrial base.

Drishti Mains Question:

"India's growing manufacturing capacity has not necessarily translated into manufacturing self-reliance." Discuss in the context of India-China trade relations.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is the “assembly trap” in India’s manufacturing sector?

It refers to **high downstream assembly with limited upstream component manufacturing** , resulting in continued dependence on imported inputs despite rising domestic production.

2. What is the role of the PLI Scheme in Atmanirbhar Bharat?

The **Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme** promotes domestic manufacturing by linking incentives to incremental production, but greater emphasis on **Domestic Value Addition and component ecosystems** is needed.

3. Why are Chinese intermediate goods important for India?

Intermediate goods constitute nearly 70% and **capital goods around 22%** of India’s imports from China, making them critical inputs for Indian manufacturing and industrial production.

4. How can India reduce dependence on China without hurting its exports?

India can adopt **calibrated tariffs, supply-chain diversification, China Plus One partnerships, domestic component manufacturing and R&D** , rather than blanket import restrictions.

5. How can MSMEs contribute to India’s manufacturing self-reliance?

Supporting **tier-2 and tier-3 MSMEs** through affordable credit, shared R&D facilities and plug-and-play manufacturing clusters can strengthen India’s **precision-component and domestic supplier ecosystem** .

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/SHnJN2A7dUQ>

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UPSC Civil Services Examination Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q. “Belt and Road Initiative” is sometimes mentioned in the news in the context of the affairs of :(2016)

- (a) African Union
- (b) Brazil
- (c) European Union
- (d) China

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. The China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) is viewed as a cardinal subset of China’s larger ‘One Belt One Road’ initiative. Give a brief description of CPEC and enumerate the reasons why India has distanced itself from the same. (2018)

World Rhino Day 2026



Source: AIR

Why in News?

Recently, **World Rhino Day** was observed on **22nd September** to raise awareness about the conservation of the world's **five remaining rhinoceros species**. The 2026 theme, **"Keep the Five Alive"**, focuses on protecting rhino habitats, preventing poaching and curbing illegal rhino horn trade.

- On this occasion, the **International Rhino Foundation (IRF)** released its **2026 State of the Rhino Report**, highlighting the status and conservation challenges of the five remaining rhino species.

What are the Key Highlights of the State of Rhino Report 2026?

- About:** The **International Rhino Foundation (IRF) State of the Rhino Report** is an annual assessment of the status, population trends and conservation challenges of the world's five remaining rhino species.
 - It uses population estimates and wildlife crime data compiled by the **IUCN** Species Survival Commission's African and Asian Rhino Specialist Groups and **TRAFFIC**.
- Global Rhino Population:** According to the latest estimates, the global rhino population stands at approximately **26,700 individuals**. Conservation outcomes remain mixed, with some species showing recovery while others continue to face severe threats.
- Species-wise Trends:**
 - Greater One-Horned Rhino:** Population increased to around **4,075**, reflecting a major conservation success due to protection and recovery efforts.
 - Black Rhino:** Population increased from **6,195 in 2022 to 6,788 in 2024**, showing continued recovery with sustained conservation action.
 - White Rhino:** Population declined from **17,464 in 2023 to 15,752 in 2024**, mainly due to poaching pressure in South Africa.
 - Javan Rhino:** Remains critically threatened, with poaching between 2019 and 2023 causing a sharp decline; continued protection is essential to prevent extinction.
 - Sumatran Rhino:** Faces severe decline due to habitat loss and reproductive challenges, with captive breeding efforts providing hope for recovery.
- Major Conservation Threats:** Rhino survival continues to be threatened by **poaching, illegal horn trade, habitat degradation and fragmentation**, particularly affecting Javan and Sumatran rhinos.
- Habitat Protection and Translocation:** Rhino conservation increasingly focuses on restoring historical habitats through translocation programmes. However, habitat quality and availability remain major challenges, especially in **Asian range countries**.

- **Breeding and Scientific Conservation:** Programmes such as the **Sumatran Rhino Sanctuary in Way Kambas National Park, Indonesia** , support semi-wild breeding and provide hope for critically endangered Sumatran rhinos.
- **Technology-Based Conservation:** Monitoring tools such as **camera traps, footprint tracking and ecological studies** are being used to identify rhino populations, understand habitat requirements and improve protection strategies.
- **Significance:** The report highlights that while conservation efforts have helped recover species like the Greater One-Horned and Black Rhino, urgent global action is required to secure the future of critically endangered Javan and Sumatran rhinos.



What are India's Efforts towards Rhino Conservation?

- **One- Horned Rhino:** India is home to the **Greater One-Horned Rhino** , primarily found in **Kaziranga National Park, Assam** . Conservation success has been supported by habitat protection, anti-poaching measures and cooperation with Nepal.
- **Zero Poaching Achievements: Assam (India)** recorded **zero known rhino poaching in 2025** , only the **second such achievement since the 1970s** . Similarly, **Nepal achieved zero rhino poaching in 2025** , marking the **10th such achievement since 2011** .
- **Population Recovery in India:** The **Dudhwa Tiger Reserve (Uttar Pradesh)** recorded an increase in its rhino population from **42 in 2022 to 53** , reflecting the success of conservation efforts. **Jaldapara and Gorumara National Parks (West Bengal)** also reported a **50% increase in the greater one-horned rhino population over a decade** .
- **New Delhi Declaration on Asian Rhinos:** India, Bhutan, Nepal, Indonesia and Malaysia have signed a declaration for the conservation and protection of the species.
- **DNA Profiles of all Rhinos:** The project will help in curbing poaching and gathering evidence in wildlife crimes involving rhinos
- **National Rhino Conservation Strategy:** It was launched in 2019 to conserve the greater one-horned rhinoceros.

RHINOCEROS

World Rhino Day - 22nd September (declared by WWF in 2010)

5 Main Species of Rhino

Species	Found in	IUCN Red List Status	Habitat
African White	Africa	NT	Long/short grass Savannah
African Black	Africa	CE	Semi-Desert Savannah
Greater one-horned	Asia	Vu (CITES - Appendix I, WPA - Schedule I)	Tropical grassland
Javan	Asia	CE	Tropical, subtropical forests
Sumatran	Asia	CE	Same as Javan

Ujung Kulon National Park (a UNESCO WHS) is home to the last remaining wild Javan rhinos on Earth

Greater One-Horned Rhino

Only species found in India (aka Indian Rhino)



CHARACTERISTICS

- Largest of the 5 species
- Identified by a single black horn and a grey-brown hide with skin folds



Threats

- Poaching for horns
- Habitat loss
- Decreasing Genetic diversity



Protected Areas (India)

- **UP**
 - Dudhwa TR
- **West Bengal**
 - Jaldapara NP
 - Gorumara NP
- **Assam**
 - Pabitora WLS
 - Orang NP
 - Kaziranga NP (max no. of Rhinos: ~2400)
 - Manas NP



Conservation Efforts (India)

- National Rhino Conservation Strategy
- Indian Rhino Vision 2020 (launched in 2005)

New Delhi Declaration on Asian Rhinos 2019

Signed by 5 rhino range nations (India, Bhutan, Nepal, Indonesia and Malaysia)



Drishti IAS

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1. When is World Rhino Day observed?

World Rhino Day is observed annually on **22nd September** to raise awareness about the conservation of rhinoceroses and their habitats.

Q2. What is the theme of World Rhino Day 2026?

The theme of World Rhino Day 2026 is **“Keep the Five Alive”**, focusing on protecting the world’s five remaining rhino species.

Q3. How many rhino species exist in the world?

There are **five species of rhinoceroses** :

- Greater One-Horned Rhino
- Black Rhino
- White Rhino
- Javan Rhino
- Sumatran Rhino

Q4. How many rhinos are left in the wild globally?

According to the **International Rhino Foundation’s 2026 State of the Rhino Report**, fewer than **27,000 rhinos** remain in the wild.

Q5. Which rhino species is found in India?

India is home to the **Greater One-Horned Rhino (Rhinoceros unicornis)**, primarily found in **Assam’s Kaziranga National Park**.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/iLRTEfQTbv0](https://www.youtube.com/embed/iLRTEfQTbv0)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions (PYQs) *Prelims*

Q. Consider the following statements: (2019)

1. Asiatic lion is naturally found in India only.
2. Double-humped camel is naturally found in India only.
3. One-horned rhinoceros is naturally found in India only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (a)

SC Mandates Strict Safeguards for Arrest and Re-arrest



Source: TH

The Supreme Court, in *Jaskaran Jeet Singh Deol v. State of Punjab (2026)* , has reinforced **Article 22 safeguards** , holding that **failure to properly communicate the grounds of arrest can render the arrest and subsequent detention illegal and unconstitutional** , while also prescribing safeguards **against re-arrest**.

- **Constitutional Mandate:** Article 22(1) of the Indian Constitution guarantees that no **arrested person shall be detained in custody without being informed**, as soon as may be, of the grounds for such arrest, **nor shall they be denied the right to consult a legal practitioner**.
- **Statutory Provisions:** Under **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), 2023**, police officers are duty-bound to communicate the full particulars of the offense to the arrested person.
- **Release from Illegal Detention, Not Bail:** The Court clarified that releasing an accused due to a violation of **Article 22(1)** is not a grant of bail, but a release from **"illegal and unconstitutional detention,"** legally treating the initial arrest as null and void.
- **Mandatory Written Grounds:** Expanding on the *Pankaj Bansal v. Union of India (2023)* judgment (which mandated written grounds under the **PMLA , 2002**), the *Mihir Rajesh Shah v. State of Maharashtra (2025)* ruling established that **written grounds of arrest must be provided across all statutes in a language the arrestee understands** .
- **Stringent Re-arrest Procedure:** Investigating agencies cannot unilaterally re-arrest an individual released on these grounds. A fresh arrest requires **explicit judicial approval from a Magistrate** .
 - Any application for re-arrest must be **endorsed by a superior police officer** , the investigation must be transferred to another officer, and a **departmental enquiry** must be initiated against the officer responsible for the initial constitutional breach.
- **Compensation for Rights Violation:** The Court held that **High Courts can award compensation** as a public law remedy for violations of **Article 22(2) (which requires production of the accused before a Magistrate within 24 hours)** , leaving the accused free to pursue private civil remedies as well.
- **Judicial Supervision over Police Powers:** The judgment reinforces that **Article 22 safeguards are sacrosanct constitutional principles, not mere procedural formalities** , strengthening judicial oversight over the **State's power to curtail personal liberty under Article 21** .

• Written grounds for arrest: SC's evolving jurisprudence

• **Article 22** is a fundamental right under the Constitution that provides for an accused to be produced before a magistrate within 24 hours of arrest, to get legal representation — and to be informed about the grounds of arrest.

• **The question** of whether an accused must be given a written copy of the grounds of arrest first arose in 'Pankaj Bansal v Union of India' (2023), where the court held a written copy must be furnished "as a matter of course and without exception".

• **That position** was diluted in 'Ram Kishor Arora v Directorate of Enforcement', which held that 'Pankaj Bansal' would apply only prospectively.

• **The court** in 'Prabir Purkayastha v State (NCT of Delhi)' in 2024 reaffirmed that an arrested person must be provided the grounds of arrest in writing at the earliest.

• **The Supreme Court** finally settled the position in 2025, in 'Mihir Rajesh Shah v State of Maharashtra', holding that grounds of arrest must be communicated in writing "in the language he/she understands", and that non-compliance would render "the arrest and subsequent remand ... illegal".

• **It allowed** grounds to be conveyed orally in exceptional cases, provided a written copy followed within a reasonable time, at least two hours before the accused was produced for remand.



Read more: [SC to Refer Grounds of Arrest Issue to Larger Bench](#)

Rising Antifungal Resistance



Source: TH

The **Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC)** hosted the **10 th Annual Fungal Disease Awareness Week (FDAW)** to highlight the growing threat of multidrug-resistant fungal infections, as scientists warn that pathogens such as ***Candida auris*** are increasingly resistant to conventional antifungal drugs, raising concerns over the effectiveness of existing treatments.

- **Fungi:** These are **eukaryotic, heterotrophic organisms** that include **yeasts, moulds and mushrooms** . Unlike plants, they **lack chlorophyll** and obtain nutrients by secreting **extracellular enzymes** and absorbing organic matter.
 - They play a vital role as **decomposers** , recycling nutrients, while also having applications in **food production, biotechnology and pharmaceuticals** , such as yeast in fermentation and **Penicillium** in antibiotic production.
 - However, certain pathogenic fungi cause **fungal infections (mycoses)** ranging from superficial diseases such as **ringworm and nail infections** to severe systemic infections, particularly in **immunocompromised individuals** .
- **Emergence of *Candida auris* :** Originally reported in 2009, this yeast has become a **multidrug-resistant pathogen in ICU facilities** , causing severe bloodstream infections with a **30-40% mortality rate** .
 - The studies suggest that **global warming** puts selective pressure on fungi, allowing heat-tolerant variants to **survive the human body's 37°C temperature** .

- **Mechanisms of Drug Resistance:**
 - **Gene Duplication:** Fungi fight azole drugs by making extra copies of the **Erg11 gene** , increasing the production of **ergosterol** to negate the drug's effect.
 - **Genetic Mutation:** Mutations in the **Fks1 gene** allow pathogens to survive high doses of echinocandin drugs like caspofungin.
 - **The Eagle Effect:** At exceptionally high drug doses, fungi activate compensatory pathways to produce massive amounts of **chitin (the raw material of the fungal cell wall)** , allowing them to survive treatment paradoxically.
- **Antifungal Drug Targets:** Traditional **azoles and polyenes target ergosterol** in the fungal cell membrane, while **echinocandins target the cell wall** .
 - Over **90% of Indian *C. auris* isolates are resistant to azoles** , and 30% are resistant to polyenes.
- **Healthcare Infrastructure Gap:** While **20% of reported hospital infections are fungal** , most Indian hospitals lack the capabilities to accurately identify and culture these pathogens.
- **Alternative Approaches:** Instead of total eradication, which drives rapid evolution, scientists advocate for **combination therapies** and targeting **less critical molecular pathways** to stop disease progression without forcing evolutionary resistance.

Comparison: Fungi vs. Bacteria vs. Viruses

Feature	Fungi	Bacteria	Viruses
Cell Type	Eukaryotic	Prokaryotic	Acellular
Cell Structure	Have nucleus and membrane-bound organelles	Lack a true nucleus and membrane-bound organelles	No cellular structure
Genetic Material	DNA	DNA	DNA or RNA
Typical Size	Generally larger than bacteria	Smaller than fungi	Smallest of the three
Nutrition	Heterotrophic , absorb nutrients from organic matter	Autotrophic or heterotrophic	Cannot obtain nutrients independently
Reproduction	Spores, budding or fragmentation	Mainly binary fission	Replicate only inside a host cell
Examples	<i>Candida auris</i> , <i>Aspergillus</i> , <i>Penicillium</i> , yeast	<i>E. coli</i> , <i>Mycobacterium tuberculosis</i>	SARS-CoV-2, Influenza virus, HIV
Diseases	Mycoses , ringworm, candidiasis	Tuberculosis, cholera, typhoid	COVID-19, influenza, dengue

Read more: [First-Ever List of Fungal Infections](#)

World Circular Economy Forum 2026



Source: PIB

Recently, the **World Circular Economy Forum (WCEF) 2026** was held in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**, under the theme “**Circular Economy: Transition for People and Prosperity**”. It was the **first time WCEF was hosted in South Asia**, focusing on practical and scalable circular economy solutions.

- The **Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)**, the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC)**, the **Government of Gujarat**, the Gujarat Pollution Control Board (GPCB), and the Finnish Innovation Fund Sitra jointly organised WCEF 2026.
- **About: WCEF** is a global platform that brings together governments, businesses, researchers, innovators and civil society to discuss and promote solutions for a circular economy.
- **Programme Structure:** WCEF 2026 focused on four key tracks — people, business, governance and growth — through plenary sessions, parallel discussions, accelerator sessions and exhibitions showcasing practical circular economy solutions.
- **Circular Economy:** A circular economy is a **sustainable model of production and consumption** that focuses on **reducing waste and extending the life cycle of products** through practices such as reuse, repair, refurbishment, remanufacturing and recycling.
 - It aims to keep materials and resources in circulation for as long as possible, creating additional value while reducing dependence on the traditional **linear “take-make-consume-dispose” model**.
- **Circular Economy Approach:** India promotes circular economy principles by integrating traditional practices of repair, reuse and resource conservation with modern strategies focused on sustainable lifestyles and efficient resource management.
- **Policy Framework:** India has strengthened circular economy efforts through regulatory reforms, improved waste management rules, **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)** frameworks and digital compliance systems to enhance recycling and resource recovery.
- **EPR Implementation:** Under various EPR frameworks, **more than 83,000 producers and 4,802 recyclers were registered, with nearly 482.24 lakh metric tonnes** of regulated waste processed, promoting a shift from waste disposal to resource recovery.
- **Mission LiFE Linkage:** The Forum emphasises **Lifestyle for Environment (LiFE)** as a foundation for promoting sustainable consumption patterns and making circular practices part of daily life.
- **International Cooperation:** India highlighted global cooperation through initiatives such as the **Resource Efficiency and Circular Economy Industry Coalition (RECEIC)** launched during India’s **G20 Presidency**.

Read More: [Circular Economy in Mobility](#)